

Teaching Evaluation Summary

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ECON 4970: Introduction to Data Science for Economists

Summer 2026 | Enrollment: 12 | Respondents: 5 (41.7%)

I taught this advanced undergraduate economics course at Georgia State University in Summer 2026. The course was designed to equip students with the skills to extract, clean, and analyze large datasets using statistical software to answer economic and policy questions. These skills are intended to prepare students for graduate study and careers involving economic data analysis. The class attracted students from different academic disciplines, with approximately 60% majoring in economics.

Course Design and Structure

The course was structured around three main modules: (1) extracting data from large, publicly available datasets; (2) organizing and managing data; and (3) analyzing, visualizing, and presenting data.

What made the class particularly interesting and engaging was the incorporation of a hands-on data analysis project. Students learned to use Stata and R to clean and analyze data from the National Longitudinal Survey of Youth 1979 (NLSY79). Each student also selected a publicly available dataset of their choice for an independent project. They cleaned and analyzed their selected datasets and presented their findings to the class. Many had never written code before, yet by the end of the course, they were producing data visualizations and conducting basic econometric analyses.

Student Engagement and Support

Recognizing that many of my students were taking a data science course for the first time and had limited programming experience, I introduced new commands by explaining their purpose and demonstrating how they worked during lab sessions. I then asked students to reproduce and modify the analyses themselves. In addition, I provided detailed lecture notes in advance and maintained both in-person and virtual office hours. I also encouraged peer tutoring, allowing students to earn extra credit by helping their classmates. These practices helped create a collaborative and supportive learning environment. My commitment to student success was reflected in their feedback and evaluation results.

Quantitative Evaluation Results

The following table summarizes student evaluation results on a 5-point scale (1=Strongly Disagree, 5=Strongly Agree):

Evaluation Criteria	Mean Score
Student achieved course objectives	5.0
Course challenged students to think	5.0
Instructor was accessible to students	5.0
Course increased ability to critically evaluate ideas	5.0
Content helped students learn the material	5.0
Instructor followed syllabus plan	5.0
Instructor was prepared for class	5.0
Instructor created environment that helped learning	5.0
Instructor communicated effectively	5.0
Grading system was explained clearly	5.0
Feedback improved student learning	5.0
I discussed ideas that I learned from this course with others outside the course	4.5
Overall Teaching Effectiveness	4.98

Among the students who completed the evaluation, I received a mean rating of 4.98/5.0 across all evaluation items. In the written comments, one student noted, “*The Instructor made the course very hands-on, which is an absolute requirement for this type of class and made it easier to grasp the concepts taught.*” I also received constructive feedback regarding the timing of instruction. Because coding demonstrations build sequentially, I sometimes waited approximately five minutes before beginning instruction to accommodate students arriving late and reduce the likelihood that they would fall behind. One student suggested beginning instruction promptly at the scheduled start time to establish clear expectations for the class. I have taken this feedback seriously and will begin instruction promptly in future courses while continuing to find appropriate ways to help students who may miss the beginning of a coding demonstration.

Please find below the complete official teaching evaluation report from Georgia State University for additional details.

Student Evaluation of Instructor

Student Evaluation of Faculty are anonymous. Responses and comments are strictly confidential. **Once submitted your Student Evaluation of Faculty could not be reset.** For more information, please visit **Student Evaluation of Faculty**. (<https://registrar.gsu.edu/registration/student-evaluation-of-faculty/>)

Andrew Young School of Policy Studies
Student Evaluation of Instructor
Summer Semester 2026

Course: 52799 ECON 4970 INTRO TO DATA SCIENCE FOR ECON
Instructor: Zachariah Emmanuel
Distribution: Online
Enrollment: 12
Respondents: 5
Percentage: 41.7

- 1=Strongly Disagree
- 2=Disagree
- 3=Neither Agree nor disagree
- 4=Agree
- 5=Strongly Agree

	1	2	3	4	5	Inst
1.I engaged in the course (face-to-face and/or online) in accordance with the instructor's syllabus policy.	0	0	0	0	3	5

2.I asked the instructor questions when I found course information unclear.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
3.I actively worked to engage ideas that I had not considered before taking this class.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
4.I achieved the course objectives outlined by the instructor.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
6.The instructor followed the plan for the course as established by the syllabus.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
7.The instructor explained the grading system clearly.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
8.The instructor was prepared for class (face-to-face and/or online).	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
9.The instructor communicated effectively.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
10.The instructor was accessible to students.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
11.The instructor created an environment that helped students learn.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
12.The feedback I received from the instructor on my work improved my learning.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
16.The course increased my ability to critically evaluate ideas.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
17.The content of this course was organized in a way that helped me learn the material.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
18.I discussed ideas that I learned from this course with others outside the course.	0	0	1	0	3		4.5
						//	//
19.This course challenged me to think.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//
20.The content of the exams and other evaluations were consistent with the material presented in the course.	0	0	0	0	4		5
						//	//

Open-ended/Free Response Questions

5. What changes in strategy or performance could I have made to enhance my learning in this course?

1. spent more time on course work ,2. Do not think I needed to make any adjustments in the course. ,3. n/a ,4. Picking a larger database.

13. What were the strengths of my instructor's course management and teaching style?

1. help was given when needed instructor went above and beyond ,2. The Instructor made the course very hands-on, which is an absolute requirement for this type of class and made it easier to grasp the concepts taught. ,3. n/a ,4. Great database to explain concepts.

14. What advice do I have for my instructor about the use of instructional time (face-to-face and/or online)?

1. none ,2. No advice, I thought time was well spent throughout the semester. ,3. n/a ,4. Start instruction as soon as class starts. It sets a precedent and expectation.

15. What did I most appreciate about how my instructor interacted with students?

1. the extra help ,2. The instructor was very open for questions and help. ,3. n/a ,4. Very flexible, easy to reach, and very helpful.

21. What, if any, assignments would you change, and why?

1. none ,2. No assignments needed changing. ,3. If it were possible to get everyone utilizing the concepts on their own datasets from the start to find defined information and the freedom to identify other insights in their final projects.

